



One month with HP OmniBook X Flip 14

A hybrid laptop that actually makes you want to flip

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There's a very specific kind of anxiety that creeps in when you're trying to type mid-commute, wedged between two strangers on a Mumbai local train, while wishing you had a cup of chai in one hand and balancing your laptop bag on a knee that's quickly falling asleep. That's the moment most ultraportables dread – where hinges start to buckle, keys begin their rattle, and plastic flexes in quiet protest.

But, thankfully, that never happened with the HP OmniBook X Flip 14, I'm happy to report.

It's not the first hybrid laptop I've used, and it certainly won't be the last, but after over a month as my daily driver – writing, sketching, streaming, commuting, and occasionally doodling while

pretending to listen on Zoom – I've found myself doing something I rarely do with review units: actually missing it when it's not around.

Build like it means it

Weighing in at 1.4-kg, the OmniBook Flip doesn't scream "ultraportable," but it feels like it was cut from the same slab of metal as more serious and sleeker machines that epitomised the pinnacle of past hybrid laptops. That's a compliment, as far as I'm concerned. There's a reassuring density to its full-metal body – a kind of industrial confidence – that shrugs off daily abuse. I shoved it into backpacks, pulled it out in meetings, left it sprawled on café tables and conference desks, and once even used it as a sketch pad while chilling on a railway

bench waiting for my Virar fast to arrive. And not once did it feel flimsy.

As far as I'm concerned, the HP OmniBook X Flip 14's hinge deserves a love letter of its own. It's not a one-finger open – this is no MacBook – but once you get used to it, you start to appreciate the torque. Whether you're flipping it into tent mode for movie nights, tablet mode for sketching, or back into clamshell mode for focused writing, the hinge holds its position without any fuss whatsoever. There's no wobbly indecision. It just stays, and I like that about it.

And then there's the keyboard – arguably one of the most overlooked casualties in the thin-and-light laptop war. HP didn't compromise here. The large, flush keys feel luxurious under your fingertips, with just the right amount of travel and dampening. I've written entire scripts, email chains, even the entirety of this review on it, and the tactile pleasure never wore off. Plus, the keyboard doesn't freak out when you flip the device into tablet mode – a small but significant design detail that signals someone actually thought this through. And what can I say about that broad and wide palmrest? Just simply good.

The OLED that earns its pixels

The HP OmniBook's 14-inch OLED display is the star of the show – crisp 2880x1800 resolution, a productivity-friendly 16:10 aspect ratio, and glorious HDR performance with full DCI-P3 coverage. To the naked eye, everything looks fantastic. Documents feel more spacious, YouTube and Netflix look borderline cinematic, and even colour-heavy layout sketches pop with clarity.

There's Gorilla Glass 3 up top, and while it picks up fingerprint smudges like a teenager's smartphone, the payoff is worth it. I used the bundled HP stylus to mark up design layouts, scribble article outlines, and even diagram an infographic for the Digit magazine. No lag, no misfires. The stylus magnetically snaps to the side with a